

Feature	Ray	Skate
Habitat	Generally found in warmer waters, including tropical and subtropical regions.	Typically found in colder waters, often in deeper parts of the ocean.
Size	Tend to be larger, with some species reaching several meters in width.	Usually smaller, with most species not exceeding 1 meter in width.
Body Shape	Flatter and more disc-like, often with a more streamlined appearance.	Slightly thicker and less streamlined, with a more rounded body shape.
Tail	Longer and whip-like, often with stinging spines.	Shorter and more stubby, usually without stinging spines.
Reproduction	Most rays are live-bearers (viviparous), giving birth to live young.	Skates are egg-layers (oviparous), laying eggs in cases known as "mermaid's purses."
Diet	Primarily feed on crustaceans, mollusks, and small fish.	Similar diet, but may also include more benthic organisms like worms.
Behavior	Often more active and can swim at higher speeds.	Generally more sedentary and move more slowly.
Senses	Highly developed electroreceptors (Ampullae of Lorenzini) for detecting prey.	Also have electroreceptors, but they are generally less developed.
Commercial Use	Some species are commercially fished for their meat and fins.	Less commonly fished commercially, but still used in some regions.
Conservation Status	Varies by species, with some being threatened or endangered due to overfishing.	Generally less threatened, but some species are still at risk.